Mission Briefing: Mission 2 – Dark Cave

Veins of Shadow: The Ontranis Descent

During the plunder of Okamec's poisoned skies, warbands uncovered a derelict comms station still clinging to power amid the fungal ruins. From its fractured arrays came a broken transmission — a psychic signature and coordinates pointing to a Voidcrown shard buried deep beneath the frozen crust of Ontranis.

The outer world offered no easy prize. Once a dutiful mining colony under the Frog-Mages' Truth, Ontranis now lies scarred by rebellion and the growing psychic storms. The shard's call drew the hunters underground into vast, lightless cave networks. A fragment of the ancient crown, if united with its lost siblings, could crown the Voidsun itself and let its bearer bend the raging psychic tempests to their will. Some descend chasing that terrible power. Others seek shelter from the lethal cold above or simply move to deny the prize to their rivals. All will learn that the dark holds its own hungers.

The caves are treacherous ground. Low ceilings choke the skies, forcing even the swiftest to tread like mortals. Without warning the rock betrays, sinkholes yawning wide to swallow units whole and spit them out elsewhere in the labyrinth. Jagged stalactites loom overhead, ready to be shattered into killing rain. And the shadows themselves hunger, striking hardest at those who linger near the edges or reveal their positions with flickering lights.

Warbands must seize and hold scattered objectives in this black maze while balancing the double-edged gift of illumination. Light reveals the foe but paints clear targets; killing the lamps invites the dark to feed. The fight will not end with a clean exfil. It will grind on until one side dominates the depths or the caves themselves grow weary of the intruders.

The Voidsun stirs above the ice. Descend. Claim the shard. Pray the shadows do not claim you first.

The abyss is watching.

MISSION 3 - DARK CAVE

MISSION BACKGROUND

The battle for Ontranis eventually led underground, whether pursuing the crystal or merely to seek shelter from the cold. Darkness is a more fearsome foe here than opposing armies, as the unwary are swallowed by deep sinkholes, and creatures await to strike from the dark.

THE BATTLEFIELD

For this mission you'll need a 6'x4' area, with 15+ pieces of terrain.

THE ARMIES

For this mission you'll need two armies of equal point cost, and players may not take any aircraft units.

DEPLOYMENT

The players roll-off, and the winner picks zone A or B to be their deployment zone, with their opponent taking the opposite. Then the players alternate in placing one unit each within section 1 of their deployment zone, starting with the player that won the deployment roll-off.

FIRST TURN

The player that has won the deployment roll-off gets the first turn.

OBJECTIVES

Before deployment, players have to set up a total of 6 objective markers.

The players roll-off to see who goes first, and then alternate in placing one objective marker each outside of the deployment zones, and at least 9" away from other objectives.

At the end of each round, if a unit is within 3" of a marker whilst enemies aren't, then the objective is seized.

Markers stay under the player's control even after leaving, but if units from both sides are contesting a marker then it becomes neutral again.

At the end of each round players get 1 VP for each objective marker they control.

Players also get 1 VP if at least one of their non-shaken units is in the enemy deployment zone, as well as 1 VP if they destroyed at least one enemy unit.

Starting from the end of round 4, players must roll one die at the end of each round, and on a 4+ the game continues.

The game ends once a 1-3 is rolled, and the player that scored most VPs wins.

SPECIAL RULES

Low Ceiling: Units with Flying count as having the Strider rule instead.

Deep Sinkhole: At the beginning of each round, players must roll one die for each unit in their army. On a 1 the unit is removed from the table, and may be placed anywhere within 6" of its original position at the end of the round.

Shoot Stalactites: When shooting at enemy units, you may choose to fire at the stalactites above the target instead. This is resolved like a regular attack with no modifiers, but for each hit the target takes D3 hits with no special rules, regardless of what weapon was used.

Shadows in the Dark: At the end of each round roll one die for each unit that is within 12" of the table edge. On a 1-3 the unit takes D3 wounds.

SPECIAL EQUIPMENT

Flashlights: All units start the game with their flashlights turned on, and when a unit is activated it may choose to turn its flashlights on/off. Enemies get +1 to hit when shooting at targets with flashlights on, and -1 to hit if they are off, however units with flashlights off always count as being within 12" of the table edge when rolling for shadows in the dark.

